

Invasive Plant Identification List

Provided here are the 23 invasive species that everyone will be surveying for along their assigned transects. Please do not rely solely on the single image in this list to identify these plants. This is simply a **LIST** of taxa to be surveyed with brief descriptions and links to additional information to familiarize us all to our invasives of interest.

**This is not an exhaustive list of the potential invasive species that you may find at your site. If you identify additional invasive taxa please document them in your survey.*



Common name: **Yellow Starthistle**
Scientific name: ***Centaurea solstitialis***
USDA plant code: **CESO3**
Identifying characteristics: Yellow flowers with long, sharp spines around the flower base.
Additional Information:
[iNaturalist](#)
[NDA](#)
[Jepson eFlora](#)
[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Russian Thistle (Tumbleweed)**
Scientific name: ***Salsola tragus***
USDA plant code: **SATR12**
Identifying characteristics: Bushy, round plant with stiff, spiny leaves that becomes a tumbleweed when mature.
Additional Information:
[iNaturalist](#)
[Jepson eFlora](#)
[Wikipedia](#)

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Common name: **Poison Hemlock**
Scientific name: *Conium maculatum*
USDA plant code: **COMA2**
Identifying characteristics: Tall plant with small white flowers and a smooth stem with purple spots.
Additional Information:
[iNaturalist](#)
[NDA](#)
[Jepson eFlora](#)
[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Musk Thistle**
Scientific name: *Carduus nutans*
USDA plant code: **CANU4**
Identifying characteristics: Spiny, deeply lobed leaves with a hairy, spiny stem
Additional Information:
[iNaturalist](#)
[NDA](#)
[Jepson eFlora](#)
[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Diffuse Knapweed**
Scientific name: *Centaurea diffusa*
USDA plant code: **CEDI3**
Identifying characteristics: #Gray-green, branching plant with narrow, deeply divided leaves and a rough, hairy stem.
Small pink or white flowers with spiny, straw-colored tips below the flowers.
Additional Information:
[iNaturalist](#)
[NDA](#)
[Jepson eFlora](#)
[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Chicory**

Scientific name: ***Cichorium intybus***

USDA plant code: **CIIN**

Identifying characteristics: Blue flowers with narrow, toothed leaves along the stem

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Bull Thistle**

Scientific name: ***Cirsium vulgare***

USDA plant code: **CIVU**

Identifying characteristics: very spiny leaves and stems

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Canada Thistle**

Scientific name: ***Cirsium arvense***

USDA plant code: **CIAR4**

Identifying characteristics: Small purple flowers with narrow, spiny leaves and spreading roots.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[NDA](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Scotch Thistle**

Scientific name: ***Onopordum acanthium***

USDA plant code: **ONAC**

Identifying characteristics: Purple flowers surrounded by many sharp, spiny leaves.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[NDA](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Blue Mustard**

Scientific name: ***Chorispora tenella***

USDA plant code: **CHTE2**

Identifying characteristics: Small pink-purple flowers with four petals and narrow, hairy leaves.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Perennial Pepperweed**

Scientific name: ***Lepidium latifolium***

USDA plant code: **LELA2**

Identifying characteristics: Small white flowers in dense clusters with broad, waxy leaves.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[NDA](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Hoary Cress / Whitetop**

Scientific name: ***Lepidium draba***

USDA plant code: **LEDR**

Identifying characteristics: Small white flowers in dense, rounded clusters with gray-green leaves.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[NDA](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Russian Olive**

Scientific name: *Elaeagnus angustifolia*

USDA plant code: **ELAN**

Identifying characteristics: Small yellow flowers followed by small olive-like fruits and silvery-gray leaves.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Jointed Goatgrass**

Scientific name: *Aegilops cylindrica*

USDA plant code: **AECY**

Identifying characteristics: Cylindrical seed heads with long, stiff, needle-like tips

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[NDA](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Cheatgrass**

Scientific name: *Bromus tectorum*

USDA plant code: **BRTE**

Identifying characteristics: Thin, drooping seed heads with long, fine, hair-like tips.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



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Common name: **Bulbous Bluegrass**
Scientific name: ***Poa bulbosa***
USDA plant code: **POBU**
Identifying characteristics: Small grass with bulb-like parts at the base of the stems and short, narrow leaves.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)
[Jepson eFlora](#)
[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Medusahead**
Scientific name: ***Taeniatherum caput-medusae***
USDA plant code: **TACA8**
Identifying characteristics: Dense seed heads with many long, thin, needle-like tips.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)
[NDA](#)
[Jepson eFlora](#)
[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Bur Buttercup**
Scientific name: ***Ceratocephala testiculata***
USDA plant code: **CETE5**
Identifying characteristics: Small yellow flowers with round seed heads covered in sharp points.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)
[Jepson eFlora](#)
[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Common Mullein**

Scientific name: *Verbascum thapsus*

USDA plant code: **VETH**

Identifying characteristics: Tall plant with a thick stem, large fuzzy leaves, and a tall spike of yellow flowers.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Tree of Heaven**

Scientific name: *Ailanthus altissima*

USDA plant code: **AIAL**

Identifying characteristics: Large leaves with many small leaf parts and small yellow-green flowers in groups.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)

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Common name: **Tamarisk / Salt Cedar**

Scientific name: *Tamarix spp.*

USDA plant code: **TAMAR2**

Identifying characteristics: Small pink flowers in clusters with tiny, scale-like leaves.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[NDA](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



Common name: **Siberian Elm**

Scientific name: *Ulmus pumila*

USDA plant code: **ULPU**

Identifying characteristics: Small green flowers and small, oval leaves with uneven edges.

Identifying characteristics:

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)

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Common name: **Puncturevine / Goathead**

Scientific name: *Tribulus terrestris*

USDA plant code: **TRTE**

Identifying characteristics: Small yellow flowers with low-growing stems and hard, sharp seed pods.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[NDA](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)

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Common name: **redstem storks bill**

Scientific name: ***Erodium cicutarium***

USDA plant code: **ERC16**

Identifying characteristics: Small pink-purple flowers with divided leaves and long, pointed seed pods.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)



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Common name: **clasping pepperweed**

Scientific name: ***Lepidium perfoliatum***

USDA plant code: **LEPE2**

Identifying characteristics: Small white flowers with round, flat seed pods and leaves that wrap around the stem.

Additional Information:

[iNaturalist](#)

[Jepson eFlora](#)

[Wikipedia](#)